Sea shell

Shells of sea snails are hardened by calcium carbonate absorbed from sea water.

Uses

This tablet *contains calcium carbonate, which is an alkali – a substance that balances out acids.*

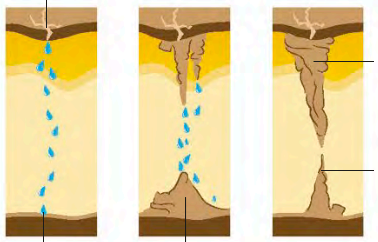
Antacid tablets

An adult **human** contains about **1 kg (2 lb) of calcium** in the body.

CALCIUM CAVES

As running water flows into caves, it deposits calcium carbonate. These deposits build up to form structures called stalactites and stalagmites.

Water with dissolved calcium carbonate flows through a crack and into the cave.



Stalactite hangs from the ceiling.

Stalagmite grows up from the ground.

Water drips onto the ground.

Over time, calcium carbonate starts to build up on the ground and ceiling.

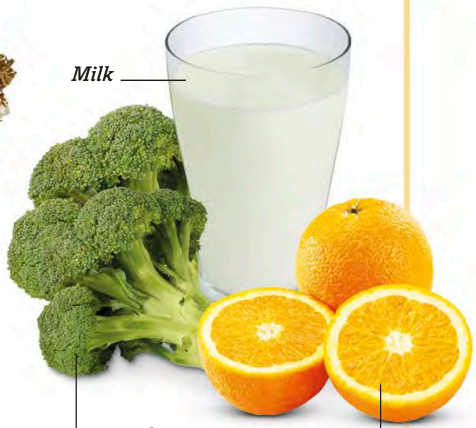
Plaster cast

This plaster of Paris cast *hardens when dry, supporting broken bones.*

Writing chalk

These chalks *contain calcium sulfate.*

Calcium-rich food



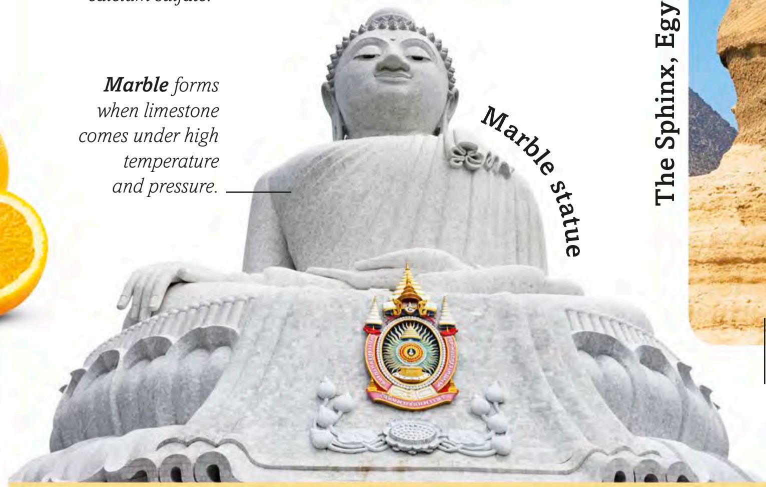
Milk

Broccoli

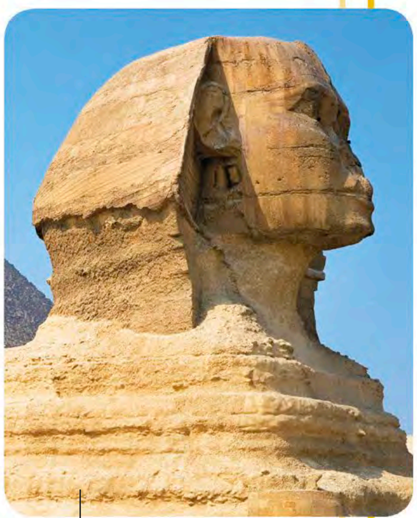
Orange

Marble *forms when limestone comes under high temperature and pressure.*

Marble statue



The Sphinx, Egypt



This statue *is made of limestone, a natural rock containing calcium carbonate.*

Oranges are also a good source of calcium, and most orange juices have extra calcium added to them. **Antacid tablets**, used to settle indigestion, contain calcium carbonate. This compound reacts with acid in the stomach. Calcium compounds are also common in construction materials. Plasterboard, which is used to make walls smooth, **writing chalk**, and **Plaster of Paris** are all made from the mineral gypsum. Calcium oxide is an important ingredient in cement and helps turn it into hard concrete.